

Image 2.2: Map of Sinkiang's boundary with Jammu and Kashmir
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

The natural barrier of the Karakoram mountains could not keep agent provocateurs from infiltrating into British India and corrupting Indian politicians with the Bolshevik virus; a term used for Soviet or Comintern agents in the period during WWI and WWII. Sheng-ts'ai's main opponent, the Islamic warlord Ma Hu-Shan, was then living in Khotan[18] close to the Ladakh border, and there was a big chance that he would spread his control into northern Ladakh, where there were no Indian Army units stationed and the borders were not defined. Thus, in 1934, the entire state was potentially under threat.

In New Delhi, officials were extremely worried about the intent and actions of Hari Singh. Once again, as in Pratap Singh's time, the northern threat dominated the discourse. Ever since Hari Singh's participation in the Round Table Conference of 1930, serious doubts about his loyalty and cooperation in the event of an emergency worried the government officials. Moreover, the internal situation in Gilgit had deteriorated to a state of